common man has made … the progress of the individual is the index of the progress of the country.' This is exactly how Modi frames his politics today. As he told a rally at Ram Lila Maidan in December 2019, 'Muslims are being misled … I have always ensured that the documents will never come in the way of development schemes and their beneficiaries.'[124]

On the question of who is an Indian, the Jan Sangh's position had very clear echoes of Savarkar's idea that India is the motherland for those whose holy lands are in India. As the party president declared:[125]

We are Bharatiya, we are not Bharatiya Lok Sangh. Lok means people. Anybody who lives in India is not a Bharatiya 'JAN'. Only he is a Bharatiya 'Jan' who loves India and looks towards India as his mother. We had discussed a lot whether our name should be Bharatiya Lok Sangh or Bharatiya Jana Sangh. We chose the word 'JAN' deliberately, because the word 'Jan' has a particular connection. Only he can be called a 'Jan' of India who looks upon Bharat as his own Janani and who owns this history, owns its past and owns its present. It is open to all of them, whatever their form of worship may be.

To be Indian, in this view, meant being Hindu—just as for the ancient Persians, for whom the sound of 'S' and 'H' were interchangeable, Sindhustan became Hindustan. 'It is strange that we take pride in calling ourselves Indians but we are ashamed in calling ourselves Hindus. The word Hindu has no religious connection. For every Indian whatever his religion may be, he is a Hindu. I will refer you to the book "SEVEN PILLARS OF WISDOM" by Lawrence of Arabia. There while describing the population of Mecca, he says that the population of Mecca is made up of Turks, Arabs and Hindus. Read that book. Indian Muslims are called Hindus. Throughout the world every Indian was known as a Hindu, whatever his religion may be. Therefore the word Hindu really means Indian. But if you take in the narrow sense, then we are not a Hindu body. We like being called Hindu in the broader sense, not in the narrower sense.'[126] Politically, the Jan Sangh had a fully formed